SLEEP-04 | Therapist only - all age groups

Worry and arousal around sleep

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Identify thoughts, sensations, and responses around rest, and choose support that does not become a struggle to fall asleep. Distinguish a practical issue to address at a suitable time from a need for listening or adjustment.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

This is not a full treatment for anxiety or a sleep disorder, exposure, trauma processing, or instructions for breath holding. Do not require thoughts to disappear, ongoing body monitoring, or repeated clock checking. Increasing distress requires stopping and appropriate assessment.

Reusing existing material

SLEEP-01 and 02 help explore context and conditions. REG-02 supports discussion of feelings and needs; here, explore pressure around rest without making a calming tool a requirement for sleep.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Yael worries in the evening about a conversation the next day. She chooses to note one question to discuss with her therapist and stops trying to solve every possibility during rest.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What is the sequence of thoughts, sensations, and responses around rest?

2 | Question for discussion

Does trying to check or solve everything increase arousal?

3 | Question for discussion

What practical issue can be addressed at a suitable time?

4 | Question for discussion

What needs support rather than an immediate solution?

5 | Question for discussion

What response can we choose that can be stopped if it becomes burdensome?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

Even a relaxation exercise can become a test. If the person repeatedly checks whether they are calm or asleep yet, simplify the response and explore the pressure instead of adding exercises.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Ask for a brief description without details of frightening content. An adult offers predictable support; the child is not expected to calm down alone or stop thinking.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Explore social and school demands without requiring details of the worry. Agree on when help is available and what remains private within the setting.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Worry may reflect a real demand. Explore available support and time to address it, not just a change in thinking. Do not postpone an urgent matter for the exercise.

OA | Older adults

Allow conversation at the person's preferred pace and distinguish worry from a medical or practical need. Do not attribute nighttime thoughts to age or expect the person to cope alone.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose one familiar response the person agrees to, or practice the conversation only in the session. Any chosen record should be brief, without repeated nighttime monitoring. It is possible to stop at any point.

At the next session

Check whether the response met the need and preserved choice. An unsuitable tool also provides useful information; thoughts do not have to disappear before moving forward.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/conditions/insomnia/
www.nhs.uk/conditions/excessive-daytime-sleepiness-hypersomnia/

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